

THE KING'S GAUNTLET

Live standings platform — opening-day traffic, edge performance, and the incident timeline.
Hosted by Hera.

Event day 2026-06-01

Window 15:00–04:00 UTC

11k visitors

148k page views

8.42M API requests

Status **recovered**, 0 data loss

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Opening day drew ~11k unique visitors and 148k page views, peaking at ~2,590 unique viewers in the 17:00 UTC hour. The platform absorbed it but hit its engineered ceilings during the peak, surfacing three same-day, viewer-facing incidents — all configuration/edge issues, all fixed by 20:00 UTC with no data loss. The edge and database-throughput layers have enormous headroom; the binding constraint for growth is long-lived SSE connections at the API tier.

11K

Unique visitors
13.4k incl. bots
(Cloudflare)

148K

Page views
~13.2k sessions

~400

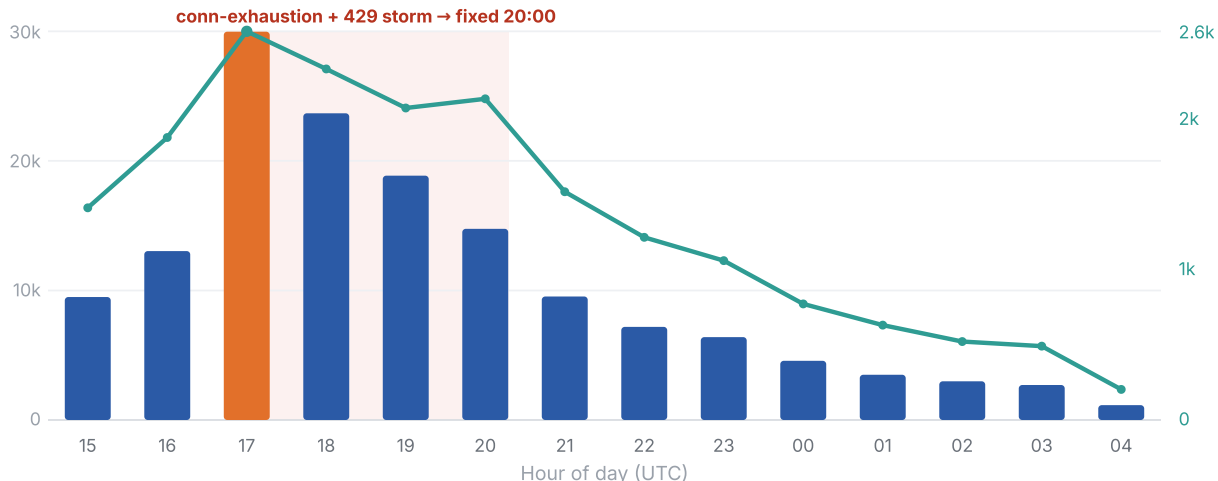
Peak concurrent
viewers
17:11 UTC marquee
spike

86%

API edge cache-hit
coalescing working

AUDIENCE & TRAFFIC

Near-zero until the 15:00 UTC pre-show, then a sharp ramp to a 17:00 peak and a long, well-behaved decay through to ~04:00. Page views fall faster than unique viewers through the evening — the audience tunes in for marquee moments and drifts.



■ Page views / hr (left axis) ■ Peak hour — 29,967 ■ Unique viewers / hr (right axis)

Source: PostHog \$pageview, project hera-streamer-invitational-2026. The 7-minute edge outage (17:31–17:38) sits inside the 17:00 bucket.

Top countries — by API requests, 24h

United States		2.06M
Germany		1.09M
Canada		535k
Sweden		368k
United Kingdom		365k
Netherlands		317k
Poland		230k

A genuinely global audience — Cloudflare zone analytics.

Session shape

13.2K

Sessions

2,590

Peak unique / hr

410

Peak unique / min
17:11 UTC

0

Uncaught FE
errors
\$exception, all day

The front end degraded gracefully — retries, not crashes.

EDGE & CACHING — Cloudflare

Cloudflare fronted the entire event. The zone absorbed ~9M requests and served 29 GB — the vast majority from cache — while the front-end Worker stayed far inside its paid-plan budget.

9.01M

Total zone requests
24h · 86.9% from cache

714K

Worker requests
24h · vs 10M/mo included

29 GB

Data served
90% cached

INCIDENT TIMELINE 2026-06-01 UTC

Three viewer-facing incidents, all configuration/edge — not raw capacity — and all resolved same-day with no data loss.

- 15:00** — Pre-show ramp begins; traffic climbs from a standing start.
- 17:10–18:40** — Peak. API pinned at 20/20 instances; Cloud SQL connections climb to the 100 cap (stale-revision accumulation) → intermittent 5xx.
- 17:31–17:38** — **Edge outage (7 min)**. The front-end Worker hits Cloudflare's free 100k-req/day cap (error 1027) — full site-shell blackout. Visible as a 7-minute hole in page views.
- 18:50–19:50** — **429 storm**. Rate limiter keyed on Cloudflare's edge IP + Vary: Cookie defeating CDN coalescing → ~80% of reads rejected; 4xx peaks at ~99k / 10 min. Client retries (standings.retry) hit 951/hr.
- 20:00** — **Resolved**. DB tier bump to 200 connections (#173) + limiter/cache fix (#176) deploy. 429s, 5xx, and retries collapse to ~0.
- 20:10–21:25** — Zero-downtime schema re-key (#179/#181) and stats windowing (#185) land cleanly under live traffic — 0× 5xx through both rollovers.

Fingerprints independently confirmed across PostHog (page-view blackout + retry spike), Cloudflare (429/500 counts), and Cloud Monitoring (instance + connection saturation).

The King's Gauntlet — Launch Day Metrics. Prepared 2026-06-02. Figures are 24h aggregates for the 2026-06-01 event window unless noted; SSE/active-viewer figures are instantaneous peaks.